PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

Part 2: Posting at the window · affixing stamps · addressing · packing special items · defence mail · post boxes · letter boxes · official articles (Section III) · prohibited articles (Section IV)

Yellow = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Clauses 20–22 Articles handed in at the window

- All **parcels**, whatever the weight → at the **counter** of a PO / mail office
- Registered newspapers + franked articles → at the counter named in the licence
- IMP Registered / insured / VP / certificate-of-posting articles → at least **half an hour before** the mail closes
- Mark clearly above the address: "Registered" / "Insured for ₹..." / "Value Payable for ₹..."
- Air mail with high-value adhesive stamps → at the window, stamps defaced in the **presence** of the person presenting it
- Posting just as the mail leaves → congestion + delay. **Post early** (Clause 22)

Clauses 23–25 How to affix stamps

- IMP Stamps → **right-hand top corner** of the address side

  📝 PYQ · Rajasthan 2021 · Maharashtra 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2021
- Stamps must stick fully to the **article itself**, not to its contents or a separate label
- Non-postal stamps, charity stamps, labels, seals → **not** on the address side (make the address hard to read)
- **No** impressions that look like a franking machine impression
- Use the minimum number of stamps (Clause 25) → many small stamps take space + add work for staff

✉️ How to write the address

- Wrong / incomplete address = delay or wrong delivery · it must be complete enough to deliver without enquiry
- Address **parallel to the length** of the cover, in the **lower half, towards the right**
- Leave at least **3 cm** clear at the top (stamps, labels, postmarks)
- Post town in **block letters**, approved spelling · foreign addresses in **Roman** letters

- Two post towns with the same name → add the **district** · district and town same name → add the **state**
- IMP Sender's address → **lower left-hand corner** or on the back

PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · MP 2020

- Concession / free articles (Book post, Blind literature) → write the class at the top of the address side
- Bulky letter that may look like another class → write "Letter" on it

Town address (order)

Name → designation / profession → house no. + street → locality → post town + PIN → mobile

Village address (order)

Name → father's / husband's name → house no. → village + thana → PO of delivery + PIN → taluka, district, state (not needed with the right PIN) → mobile

Machine-sortable envelopes (standard): receiver's address on the front, sender's on the back · **15 mm** blank on left, bottom, right · address block **40 mm** below the top · stamps / frank 10 mm from the address · **15 mm** at the bottom for the barcode · logo max 25 × 50 mm

The President and certain high officers get mail even on tour (list in Clause 206) → address such articles "Camp", not a post town.

👀 **At a glance: stamps and address**

½ hr	3 cm	15 mm	40 mm
registered before close	top margin	edges / barcode	address from top

⚠️ **Exam trap**

Stamps go **top right**, but the sender's address goes **bottom left**. Don't swap them.

💡 **Remember**

"**Stamp sits up-right, sender sits down-left**"

📦 Packing special items

- Parcels in a strong case / wrapper · cloth / woollens → strong wrapper + outer cover · wooden or stout cardboard box is best
- **Live bees** → in cases that can't hurt other mail or staff

- **Liquids** → **double receptacle**: bottle inside, metal / strong wooden box outside, saw-dust / bran in between (to absorb)
- **Human viscera** → may go to Chemical Examiners · brains of rabid animals to authorised labs · glass bottle, tight stopper (wax if alcohol), in a wooden / tin box with **18 mm cotton**, cloth outside, seals every **3 inches**
- **Plague cultures** → only from authorised doctors / with govt permission, to a govt lab · hermetically closed + 18 mm layer + declaration
- **Osmic acid** → sealed glass capsule, in a tin of sand (at least **4.3 cm**), wooden box outside + 2.5 cm cotton · red letters "OSMIC ACID" · max **2 grams** per capsule
- **Perfumes** → plugged bottle, cardboard box, then wooden box · red letters "Perfumes - keep away from fire"

> 💡 **Remember**
> Liquid = **"bottle inside a box"** · osmic acid = **2 grams** · viscera / cultures = **18 mm** cotton

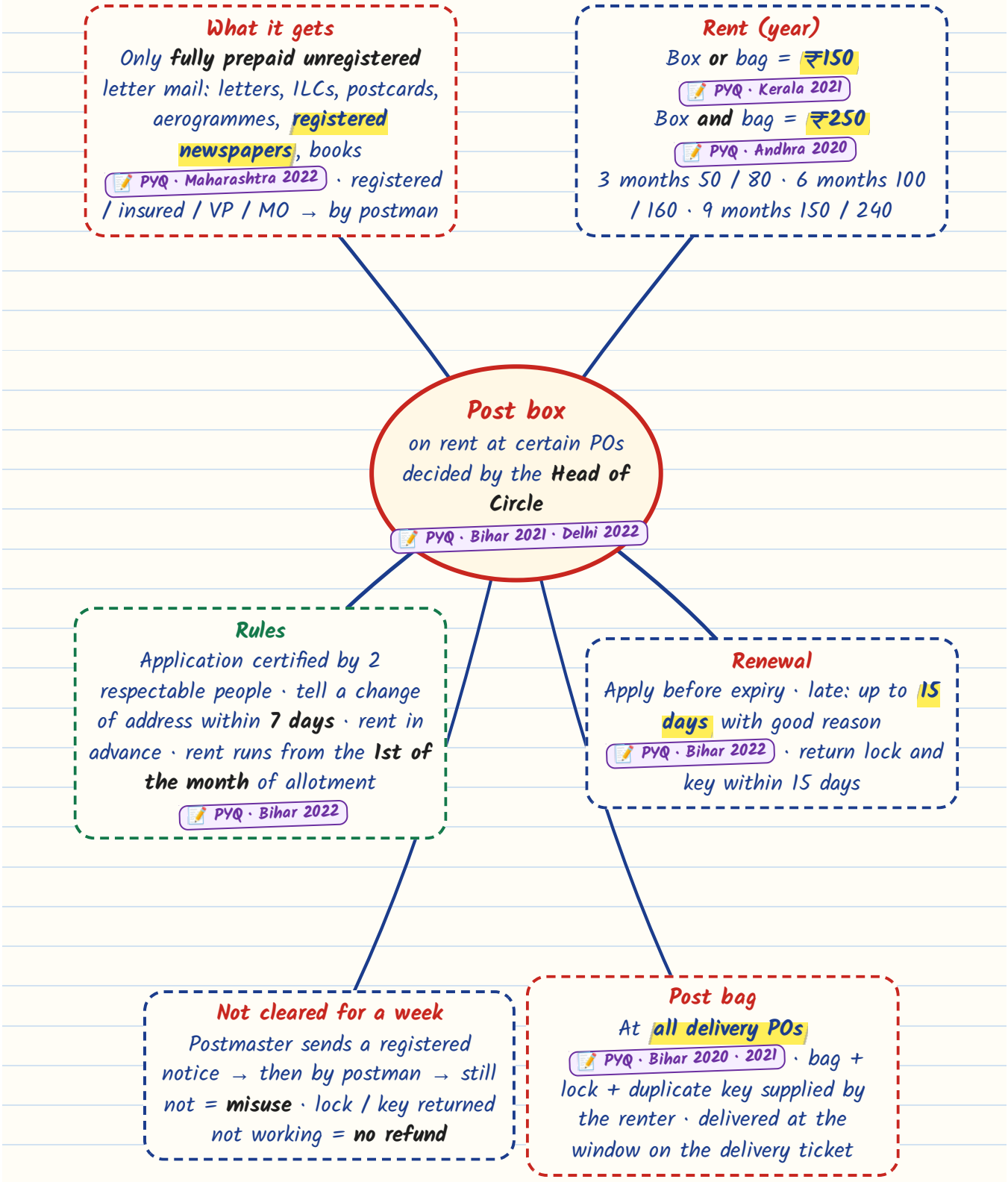
Clauses 27–31 Army, navy, addresses

- IMP Army / Air Force personnel → PIN of **56 APO or 99 APO**, **no post town**
  📝 PYQ · Maharashtra 2022
- IMP Navy personnel on INS ships → **C/o Fleet Mail Office, Bombay** + number, rank, ship's name
  📝 PYQ · Punjab 2021 · Chhattisgarh 2022 · Bihar 2021 · MP 2020 · Odisha 2021
- **Indefinite address** = not delivered: addressed to a class of people, only initials / figures / fictitious names · **unless** in care of a definite person or place (house, post box, street number)
- Registered / insured / VP / MO → only to a **definite person or firm**
- Sender's name + address (with PIN) in the **lower left** corner → returned unopened if not delivered (Clause 30)
- Many undelivered articles are destroyed every year in RLOs · for photographs in packets write the address on the back too
- When giving your address to people abroad, always mention the **state** (Clause 31)

Definite ✓ (delivered)	Indefinite ✗ (not delivered)
The Chief Secretary to the Government of HP, Shimla	Chief Secretary, Shimla
The Occupant, No. 10 Park Street, Kolkata	The non-commissioned officer, Meerut
President, Officers' Mess, **Mathura** (only one mess)	President, Officers' Mess, **Delhi** (many messes)

The certificate of posting service was discontinued in 2011 (not in syllabus).

Post box / Post bag · Mind map



Post box: other points

- Articles "C/o Post Box" are not put in the box, except for: the firm's staff, family / guests, trainees of an institution, visitors staying with the renter
- Several renters may share one box, but **each pays a separate fee** · no right to a particular number / row
- Wrong information or misuse → box withdrawn without notice
- Key lost → pay for the key only · lock (or both) lost → pay for both · not reporting = allotment cancelled
- Delivery ticket = same number as the box, **not transferable** · clearance may be stopped up to half an hour before each delivery
- Article too big for the box → intimation slip inside, collect at the window · too much mail → extra box with the **same number**

👀 At a glance: Post box

₹150	₹250	7 days	15 days	1 week
box or bag / yr	both / yr	report address change	late renewal	not cleared → notice

⚠️ Exam trap

Post **boxes** = at certain POs, but post **bags** = at **all delivery POs**.

💡 Remember

"**150 single, 250 pair**" (₹150 one, ₹250 both)

Letter box attendant (LB peon)

- IMP Main duty = **clearing the letter boxes of his beat on time**

  📝 PYQ · Tamil Nadu 2020 · Haryana 2020 · Andhra 2020
- Stamping, sealing, unloading mail · reports damaged boxes to the postmaster · knows clearance and mail times
- Gets keys + hour plates + a bag from the postmaster before leaving · returns them at once · keys always kept by the postmaster
- May carry mail to town SOs / BOs, work as packers · **no MO payments other than TMOs**
- **Nayatha software + PMA app**: scan the barcode inside the box → GPRS to the server, GPS checked
- Who clears: GDS DA / MTS / Postman · office boxes → **BPM** in a BO, GDS DA / MTS / Mail PA in SOs / HOs

Section III — Official postal articles (Clauses 198–207)

📝 PYQ · Bihar 2021

- Same rates and rules as non-official mail · exceptions: "Service Unpaid" postcards, parcels with official files
- Department of Posts officers, Postal Audit officers → departmental mail **free**
- Superscription **OIGS (On India Government Service)** or **On Service** + sender's **signature + full designation** (lower left)
- Service postcards already carry "Service" → nothing more needed · known abbreviations may be accepted, but no one can claim it
- IMP Unpaid official article → charged the **prepaid rate** on delivery · underpaid → **only the deficiency** 📝 PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Andhra 2020 · Kerala 2021
- Prepayment on parcels is **compulsory** · an official parcel with dues goes back to the sender
- Entitled to service stamps: Central, State, local bodies, judiciary · authorised by the **DG** (later changes: Head of Circle) · officials on leave / retired: **no**
- A postal ballot = an official postal article
- Mail of local fund / local authority officers = **not** official (can't use OIGS)
- Ordinary stamps used instead of service stamps → the PO in charge reports it to the sending office · repeated → to the **CPMG**
- Govt officer → private person: official, prepaid · exceptions: certified court copies, govt books → "Service Unpaid", charged on delivery
- Govt officers **must** pay postage due on articles addressed to them · **not** with service stamps

Camp mail (Clauses 205–206)

- High constitutional / govt officers on tour → their mail in a **special registered mail bag** (Camp Correspondence)
- Only fully prepaid, uninsured letter mail · addressed "Camp", no post town · bags delivered on **Sundays + holidays** too
- Parcels, MOs, insured, VP with dues → **not** in special bags · no redirection in transit
- Camp bag (files): as parcel → max **10 kg**, postage of a 10 kg parcel + registration + **₹16** · as air parcel → + **₹6** · as letter mail → registration fee only · 2 labels (address + tag)
- Tour programme given in time to the Department (Council of Ministers → **DG Post, New Delhi**) · changes to them + the local superintendent

✍️ **Test yourself**

1. Mail for INS ships goes in care of?
2. Yearly rent for post box + bag?
3. Where is the post bag facility?
4. Charge on an underpaid official article?
5. Top margin above the address?

Answers: 1 Fleet Mail Office, Bombay · 2 ₹250 · 3 All delivery POs · 4 Only the deficiency · 5 3 cm

Section IV Prohibited articles (Clause 209) 📝 PYQ · Haryana 2020

- ✗ Anything sent against any law in force
- ✗ Indecent paintings, photos, books, cards 📝 PYQ · Andhra 2021
- ✗ Indecent, seditious, threatening words on the cover
- ✗ Explosive, inflammable, dangerous, filthy things · **matches** count as explosives
- ✗ Inflammable liquids: flash point below **200°F** · spirits 90°F or below · turpentine · all varnishes
- ✗ Harmful living creatures
- ✗ IMP **Lottery** tickets / adverts 📝 PYQ · MP 2020 · govt lotteries exempt (declaration + name and address)
- ✗ Newspapers not following the Press & Registration of Books Act 1867
- ✗ IMP Gold coins / bullion / ornaments over **₹1 lakh** (earlier ₹20,000) 📝 PYQ · Kerala 2021
- ✗ Coins, currency notes (DG may allow for specific purposes)
- ✗ Address side split into several parts (more than one address)
- ✗ Dangerous goods, narcotics, items banned by IATA / ICAO / wildlife · batteries banned by air → surface only

Don't use pins to join reply postcards or packet covers (they injure other mail).

Local prohibitions (Clause 210)

- → Anywhere in India: **opium, morphia, coca leaves, bhang, ganja, charas, cocaine** → prohibited · exempt: recognised medicines, govt consignments, licensed chemists (permit + declaration)
- → Skins / feathers of birds other than domestic birds → prohibited (exempt: ostrich feathers, natural history specimens to / from Port Blair)
- → **Kutch** out of J&K → only with a permit from the Conservator of Forests, Kashmir
- → Pests / disease: plants with **San Jose** scale from several states · **Icerya purchasi** from TN, Kerala, Karnataka · **bananas** from Maharashtra, Kerala, Odisha (Bunchy top disease)

Injurious and suspect articles (Clauses 211–213)

- Suspected injurious → postmaster detains it and refers to the **Head of Circle**
- Articles with pins: found at the booking PO → returned at once · found later → returned through the RLO, pins removed
- Goods against the law → returned to the sender · only suspected → forwarded marked "Doubtful", opened in the **presence** of the addressee
- Imported gold / jewellery → only after **customs duty** is paid
- Matter against law and order, harmful to a community, or a picture of a proclaimed offender → not sent, if found → **RLO**

👀 At a glance: Prohibited

₹1 lakh	200°F	1867	Section 19
gold limit	flash point	newspaper Act	prohibited

⚠️ Exam trap

Matches count as "explosives" · **government lotteries** are not prohibited.

💡 Remember

Gold **not above 1 lakh** · top banned trio "**L-G-M**" = Lottery, Gold, Matches

✍️ Test yourself

1. Gold above what value can't go by post?
2. A suspect article is opened in whose presence?
3. Which lottery tickets are not prohibited?
4. Bananas can't be sent from which states?

Answers: 1 ₹1 lakh · 2 The addressee · 3 Government lotteries · 4 Maharashtra, Kerala, Odisha

Source: PO Guide Part I · MTS / Postman notes, pages 28–54, condensed